

Madura Herath

Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

MSc in Innovation and Design (Completed with VG (A) grades for all the courses)

Mälardalen University, Eskilstuna, Sweden

Aug 2024 – June 2026

MSc in Information Management (Merit)

Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology, Sri Lanka

Jun 2022 – Jun 2024

BSc in Business and Management Studies (Second Class, Division One)

Cardiff Metropolitan University, United Kingdom

Oct 2016 – Oct 2018

Higher National Diploma in Business Management (Merit)

National Institute of Business Management (NIBM), Sri Lanka

Oct 2015 – Oct 2016

Higher National Diploma in Business Management (Merit)

National Institute of Business Management (NIBM), Sri Lanka

Oct 2014 – Oct 2015

WORK EXPERIENCE

Master's Thesis Internship, SCAILAB, Sweden.

Jan 2026 – May 2026

Business Analyst, Innodata, Sri Lanka

Jun 2023 – Jul 2024

Business Analyst, hSenid Mobile, Sri Lanka.

Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

Business Analyst, Emjay International, Sri Lanka

Mar 2020 – Oct 2022

Executive – Warehouse, Emjay International, Sri Lanka

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

HR Intern, MAS Holdings, Sri Lanka

Aug 2017 – Feb 2018

Operations Trainee, Medigain, Sri Lanka

Jan 2017 – Jun 2017

Intern, Luckyland Biscuit Manufacturers, Sri Lanka

Aug 2016 – Oct 2016

THESIS

Calibrating Engineers Trust in LLM-based support in SCAILAB Synthetic Data Pipeline.

2026 (in progress)

Mälardalen University, Eskilstuna, Sweden.

Conducted a qualitative case study on how engineers experience, evaluate, and trust LLM-based support in a synthetic data pipeline for robotics. The study examined trust, verification effort, workflow fit, and engineer-LLM mismatches through semi-structured interviews, think-aloud sessions, screen recordings, and thematic analysis, with the aim of informing human-centered design recommendations for more trustworthy AI support in engineering workflows.

Sentimental Analysis of IMDB Movie Reviews: A Comprehensive Study 2024
Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT), Sri Lanka.

Conducted a comparative study of sentiment analysis on IMDb movie reviews using natural language processing and machine learning. Built a workflow that included web scraping, text preprocessing, Bag-of-Words feature extraction, and sentiment classification with Multinomial Naïve Bayes, Decision Tree, and K-Nearest Neighbor models, then extended the analysis to compare sentiment patterns across movie genres.

ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Gamification in Mobile E-Commerce Apps and User Purchase Decisions. 2025
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Conducted a qualitative study on how gamification features in mobile shopping apps influence purchase decisions. Used semi-structured interviews, a focus group, and thematic analysis to identify key themes such as engagement drivers, behavioural influence, emotional responses, design usability, social dynamics, and user preference for optional or balanced gamification.

Customer Satisfaction in Pre-Purchase Support Using E-Commerce AI Chatbots 2025
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Explored the key factors affecting customer satisfaction when using AI chatbots during the pre-purchase stage of e-commerce. Designed a qualitative research framework using think-aloud protocol, scenario-based testing, and grounded theory to examine how personalization, response quality, usability, and operational efficiency shape customer experience.

Journey Planning Features in Swedish Public Transport Apps and Commuter Satisfaction 2026
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Investigated how journey-planning features in Swedish public transport apps affect commuter satisfaction. Applied surveys, semi-structured interviews, and thematic analysis to evaluate app performance, personalization, reliability, and functionality, highlighting the importance of real-time updates, route accuracy, and usability in commuter experience.

PROJECTS

Project: INSIGHTS App Redesign – UX/UI Project 2026
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Conducted a UX/UI redesign project for the INSIGHTS personal development micro-learning app for iOS. Applied user-centered design methods, including research, workshops, iterative prototyping, and user testing, to improve usability, engagement, reflection, and learning retention through simplified navigation, card-based interactions, a reflection diary, and a daily streak feature.

Case Study: Develop a framework to balancing Innovation and Efficiency in Public Sector Governance: The Case of Lidingö Municipality, Sweden 2025
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Conducted a case study in collaboration with Lidingö Municipality to explore how public sector organizations can balance innovation with operational efficiency. Used interviews and participatory observation to develop a practical framework addressing governance challenges and supporting internal reform and leadership development.

Project: Concept Design and Development of Toolshare App 2024
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Developed a concept for a tool-sharing application aimed at promoting sustainable consumption. Worked with students from Västerås Folkhögskola to gather insights through interviews, workshops, and prototype testing, and used the findings to refine the design in alignment with UN Sustainable Development Goal 12.

Project: Improving Digital Accessibility for Students with Disabilities – Mälardalen University Library 2025
Mälardalen University, Sweden

Developed and tested an interactive prototype to improve the accessibility and usability of the Mälardalen University Library website. Used expert interviews, target group interviews, workshops, and usability testing to identify barriers and propose improvements in navigation, search, accessibility modes, and screen reader and keyboard compatibility.

Project: Data Warehouse for Restaurant Data 2022
Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology (SLIIT)

Designed and implemented a SQL-based data warehouse using a star schema to centralize data from 10 sources. Improved ETL efficiency and query performance, enabling analysis of more than 5,000 monthly transactions and supporting data-driven decision-making.

Project: Mobile Application to find Historical Places in Sri Lanka 2022
Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology, Sri Lanka

Developed a concept for a mobile application designed to help users locate historical places in Sri Lanka. Designed wireframes and proposed a hybrid development approach using A-GPS, web services, Google Maps API, Places API, and Directions API to support location-based travel planning.

Case Study: Performance Improvement of the order delivery process of Luckyland Biscuits Manufacturers of Sri Lanka 2015
National Institute of Business Management, Sri Lanka

Conducted a case study on improving the order delivery process of Luckyland Biscuits Manufacturers of Sri Lanka. Analyzed existing workflows using ISO 9001:2008 principles and proposed process improvements to enhance efficiency, reliability, and service performance.

Case Study: Factors affecting employee stress among banking employees of Sri Lanka

2014

National Institute of Business Management (NIBM), Sri Lanka

Conducted a survey-based study examining factors influencing workplace stress among frontline banking employees in Sri Lanka. Analyzed demographic and workplace variables, including age, gender, income, experience, job attitude, and supervisor relationships, to identify patterns associated with employee stress.

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

In-Preparation

Herath M, Alsén A, Hodzic A (2026) Balancing Exploitation and Exploration in Municipalities. CINet 2026 Continuous Innovation Network Conference

TECHNOLOGY COMMUNICATION/OUTREACH

1. Herath M, Medium (2025) *Chinese App Design: Why Complexity Wins in the Chinese Digital Landscape*. Available at: <https://medium.com/@blogmadura/chinese-app-design-why-complexity-wins-in-the-chinese-digital-landscape-4699ea3527fb>
2. Herath M, Medium (2025) *AI Sweden: Empowering Innovation with Artificial Intelligence*. Available at: <https://medium.com/@blogmadura/ai-sweden-empowering-innovation-with-artificial-intelligence-ca196c798d6d>
3. Herath M, AI Monks (2023) *Microsoft Orca: Leading the Way in AI Reasoning*. Published in AI Monks.io. Available at: <https://medium.com/aimonks/microsoft-orca-leading-the-way-in-ai-reasoning-7f241d5af31>
4. Herath M, AI Monks (2023) *What is PaLM 2 - Pathways Language Model?* Published in AI Monks.io. Available at: <https://medium.com/aimonks/palm-2-6fb006a5fd24>
5. Herath M, AI Monks (2023) *Falcon 40B: Redefining the Limits of Open-Source LLMs*. Published in AI Monks.io. Available at: <https://medium.com/aimonks/falcon-40b-redefining-the-limits-of-open-source-llms-e96faa907192>
6. Herath M, AI Monks (2023) *Prompt Engineering Techniques - Part 2*. Published in AI Monks.io. Available at: <https://medium.com/aimonks/prompt-engineering-techniques-part-2-a68744647617>
7. Herath M, AI Monks (2023) *Prompt Engineering Techniques - Part 1*. Published in AI Monks.io. Available at: <https://medium.com/aimonks/prompt-engineering-techniques-part-1-119f1e94b9a4>

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

1. AI tools (**Advanced**) in OpenAI, Claude, OpenCode, prompt engineering, MCP, agentic workflows, LLM-based prototyping, and AI automation using Python
2. SQL programming (**Intermediate**) in relational database management
3. Experience in Data Visualization (**Advanced**) software of Power BI, Tableau, Qlik View, Qlik Sense
4. Experience in Project Management (**Advanced**) softwares of JIRA, Confluence, Basecamp, MS Project.
5. Experience in Design, UI/UX (**Advanced**) softwares of Balsamiq Wireframes, Figma, Adobe XD.
6. Experience in Collaborative and workflow tools (**Advanced**) softwares of Microsoft Visio, Miro.
7. Experience in graphical and video editing software (Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere, Adobe Lightroom, Adobe illustrator)

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATIONS

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|---|------|
| 1. Excel Skills for Business: Essentials: Macquarie University | 2018 |
| 2. The complete SQL Bootcamp 2022: Go from Zero to Hero: Udemy | 2022 |
| 3. Python for Beginners: University of Moratuwa | 2022 |
| 4. JIRA Fundamentals Badge: Atlassian | 2022 |
| 5. Introduction to Psychology: University of Toronto | 2022 |
| 6. Fundamentals of Visualization with Tableau: University of California, Davis | 2022 |
| 7. Transformer Models and BERT Model: Google Cloud Skill Boost | 2023 |
| 8. Introduction to Large Language Models: Google Cloud Skill Boost | 2023 |
| 9. Introduction to Generative AI: Google Cloud Skill Boost | 2023 |
| 10. Attention Mechanism: Google Cloud Skill | 2023 |
| 11. Analyzing and Visualizing data in Looker: Google Cloud Skills Boost | 2025 |
| 12. Model Context Protocol, Advanced Topics: Anthropic | 2026 |

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Proficient in English

Basic in Swedish (Continuous learning through SFI)

REFERENCES

Available Upon Request